assume the primary responsibility for the entrenched coloniality at the level of the society. Critically, this entrenchment was facilitated by continuing with colonial education that has played a significant role in colonialising successive generations, and it is not an easy task by any standard to reverse the damage already done.

Further, apart from the apparatus of the State, the indigenous society of Bharat too must take some measure of responsibility for leaving matters of culture and civilisation entirely to the State, which goes against the grain of its civilisational thinking. In the process, over the decades, Bharat's indigenous society has ceded its institutional independence and capabilities at the feet of the State. As a consequence, it now finds itself deprived of means of self-reliance and at the mercy of a State that, for the most part, has pandered to the very colonialities whose animus towards Indic consciousness is a matter of historical fact. Therefore, notwithstanding the time, effort and resources that may be required, decoloniality is an existential civilisational imperative that must be undertaken, at the very least in the critical realms of nature, knowledge and faith (which are interconnected), history, education, development and the law in order for the society to reflect its civilisational consciousness in its future electoral priorities, choices and policies.

Third, from the perspective of treatment of various sub-identities that form part of the larger Indic civilisational fabric, recognition of the federal character of this civilisation is critical from the perspective of formulation of law and policy, which have a bearing on the sub-identities and their relationship with the whole. This is particularly relevant in the realms of faith, history, production of knowledge, education, language and preservation of ways of life, including personal laws. Therefore, when 'uniformity' in any realm, including and especially in civil law, is the subject of deliberation, the federal character of this civilisation and the reasons for its survival must be borne in mind before resorting to a European-style 'national' treatment of a federal civilisation. At least in the context of Bharat, the whole is as strong as its parts and the survival of the parts is contingent on the existence of the whole. Preserving this balance is easier said than done but as long as the State is committed to preserving this balance and is also *seen* as being committed to it, it would be keeping intact the civilisational, political and territorial integrity of Bharat by protecting it against centrifugal impulses, either homegrown or external.